

Gated Graph Recurrent Neural Networks

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RNN Background

hidden state evolution:

$$z_t = \sigma(Ax_t + Bz_{t-1})$$

output:

$$y_t = \rho(Cz_t)$$

where:

- x_t = input
- z_t = hidden state
- y_t = output
- A, B, C = parameter matrices; σ, ρ = nonlinearities (pointwise)

Limitations of RNNs

Problem:

Graph processes contain both

time structure

and

graph structure.

The graph topology is ignored by a standard RNN.

Graph Signal Processing

Graph:

$$\mathcal{G} = (\mathcal{V}, \mathcal{E}, \mathcal{W})$$

where $\mathcal{W}$ denotes a weight function on edges.

Signal:

$$x \in \mathbb{R}^N$$

where node i stores value x_i .

Graph Shift Operator

Graph structure encoded by:

$$S \in \mathbb{R}^{N \times N}$$

Examples:

- adjacency matrix
- Laplacian
- random-walk matrix

Local diffusion:

$$Sx$$

Each node aggregates information from neighbors.

Diffusion Interpretation

Repeated shifts:

$$S^2x, \quad S^3x, \dots$$

Interpretation:

- $Sx = 1$ -hop information
- $S^2x = 2$ -hop information
- $S^kx = k$ -hop information

Graph propagation becomes localized and distributed.

Graph Convolution

Linear Shift Invariant Graph Filter:

$$A(S)x = \sum_{k=0}^{K-1} a_k S^k x$$

Properties:

- local computation
- K-hop receptive field
- parameter sharing
- graph analogue of convolution

Graph Processes

Graph process:

$$\{x_t\}_{t \in \mathbb{N}}$$

Remarks:

- graph signal evolving over time
- fixed topology
- changing node values

It needs:

Graph structure + Temporal memory

Graph Recurrent Neural Networks

Main Idea of GRNN

Replace dense matrices by graph filters.

Classical RNN:

$$Ax_t + Bz_{t-1}$$

GRNN:

$$A(S)x_t + B(S)z_{t-1}$$

Result:

- spatial modeling
- temporal modeling

hidden state evolution:

$$z_t = \sigma (A(S)x_t + B(S)z_{t-1})$$

it addresses:

- input graph filtering
- recurrent graph filtering
- nonlinear update

GRNN Filters

Input filter:

$$A(S) = \sum_{k=0}^{K-1} a_k S^k$$

State filter:

$$B(S) = \sum_{k=0}^{K-1} b_k S^k$$

Only K coefficients per filter.

Parameter count does not grow with graph size.

$BS(S)$ may lead to oversmoothing! and other problems!

Gated Graph Recurrent Neural Networks

Why Gating?

Problem:

- vanishing gradients
- exploding gradients
- long temporal dependencies
- oversmoothing and oversquashing

Generic Gated GRNN (GGRNN)

hidden state evolution:

$$Z_t = \sigma\left(\hat{Q}\{A_S(X_t)\} + \check{Q}\{B_S(Z_{t-1})\}\right)$$

where

$\hat{Q} : \mathbb{R}^{N \times H} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^{N \times H}$ is the input gate operator, and

$\check{Q} : \mathbb{R}^{N \times H} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^{N \times H}$ is the forget gate operator.

Depending on the gating strategy (time gating, node gating, edge gating, etc.) they may have different forms.

input gate state:

$$\hat{Z}_t = \hat{\sigma}(\hat{A}_S(X_t) + \hat{B}_S(\hat{Z}_{t-1})) \in \mathbb{R}^{N \times \hat{H}}$$

forget gate state:

$$\check{Z}_t = \check{\sigma}(\check{A}_S(X_t) + \check{B}_S(\check{Z}_{t-1})) \in \mathbb{R}^{N \times \check{H}}$$

Gates are themselves generated by GRNNs.

Time Gating GRNN (t-GGRNN)

Input gate:

$$\hat{Q}\{A_S(X_t)\} = \hat{q}_t A_S(X_t)$$

Forget gate:

$$\check{Q}\{B_S(Z_t)\} = \check{q}_t B_S(Z_t)$$

Global scalar gates.

Time Gate Parameters

Gate values:

$$\hat{q}_t = \text{sigmoid}(\hat{c}^T \text{vec}(\hat{Z}_t))$$

$$\check{q}_t = \text{sigmoid}(\check{c}^T \text{vec}(\check{Z}_t))$$

Interpretation:

- similar to LSTM
- controls temporal memory
- same gate for all nodes

Node Gating GRNN (n-GGRNN)

Input gate:

$$\hat{Q}\{A_S(X_t)\} = \text{diag}(\hat{q})A_S(X_t)$$

Forget gate:

$$\check{Q}\{B_S(Z_t)\} = \check{\text{diag}}(\check{q}_t)B_S(Z_t)$$

$$\hat{q}_t = \text{sigmoid}(\hat{C}_S(\hat{Z}_t))$$

$$\check{q}_t = \text{sigmoid}(\check{C}_S(\check{Z}_t))$$

Node Gating GRNN (n-GGRNN)

Motivation:

Different graph regions may exhibit different dynamics.

Idea:

- one gate per node
- node-dependent memory
- spatially adaptive recurrence

Motivation:

Some edges should be active, others should be suppressed.

Idea:

- gate every edge
- adaptive information flow
- graph-dependent attention mechanism